



The Little Prince: A Universal Voyage

Exploring the Dzongkha Edition of Antoine de Saint-Exupéry's Masterpiece

While the script on this cover reads 'Gyalse Zhan Nu' (The Little Prince), the watercolor of the boy on Asteroid B-612 is a universal icon. This presentation serves as a visual companion to the 2014 Bhutanese edition, bridging the gap between the Dzongkha text and the English narrative essence.

A Gift to the Children of Bhutan

ཁྱེད་ལ་ཕྱི་མ་གཞིན་ལྟུ།

The original title of this book: *Le Petit Prince*.

Translated from French into Dzongkha in 2014 by Dr. Tandin Dorji and Phurba,
Faculty members of the Institute for Management Studies, Olakha, Thimphu, Bhutan.

The Dzongkha Version of "Le Petit Prince" (ཁྱེད་ལ་ཕྱི་མ་གཞིན་ལྟུ།) is the initiative of the Jean-Marc Probst Foundation for Le Petit Prince at Lausanne.

www.fondation-probst-petit-prince.com www.petit-prince-collection.com

The free distribution of this book to all schools in Bhutan was made possible thanks to the kind support of Dr. Frederik Paulsen.

The translators would like to thank the following:

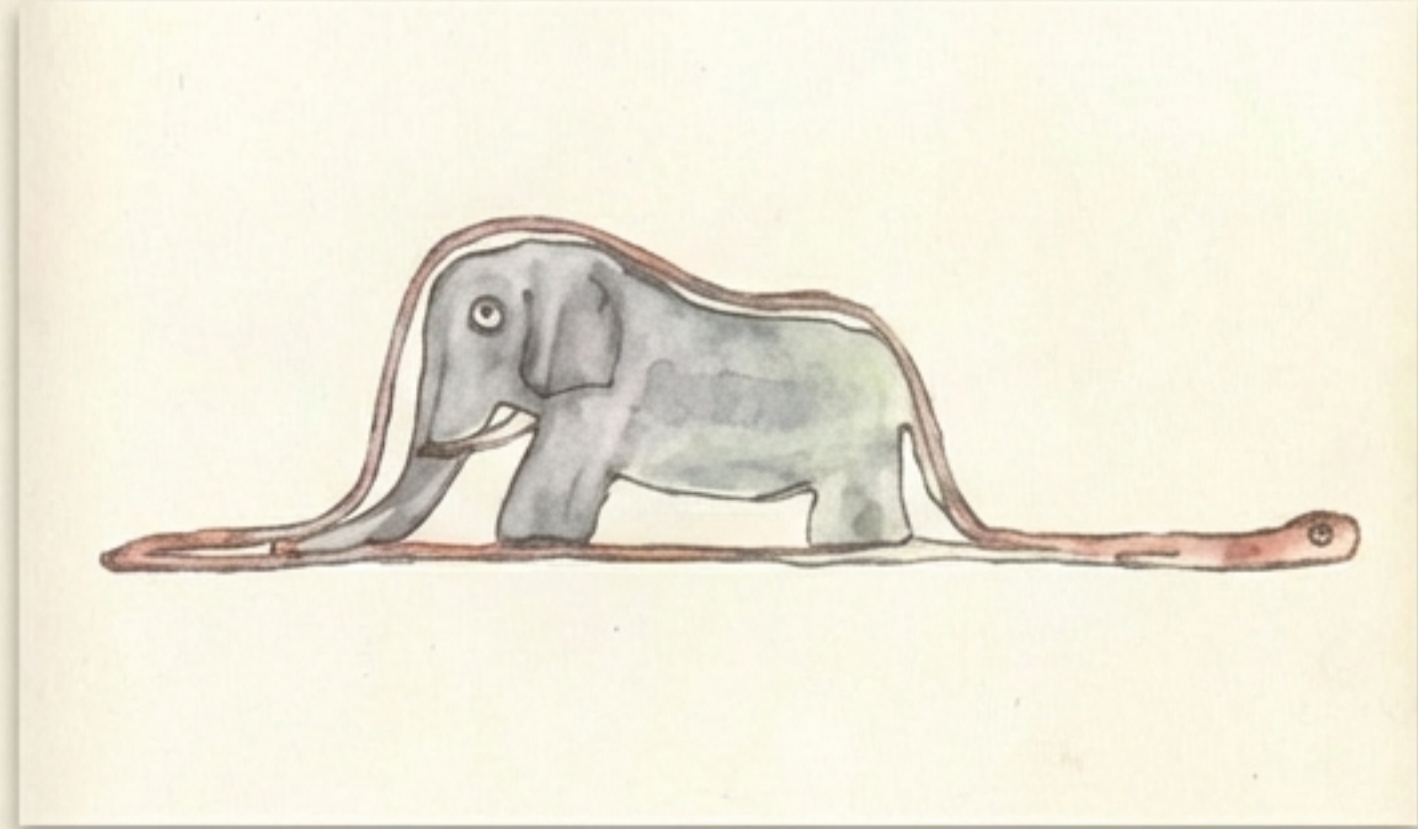
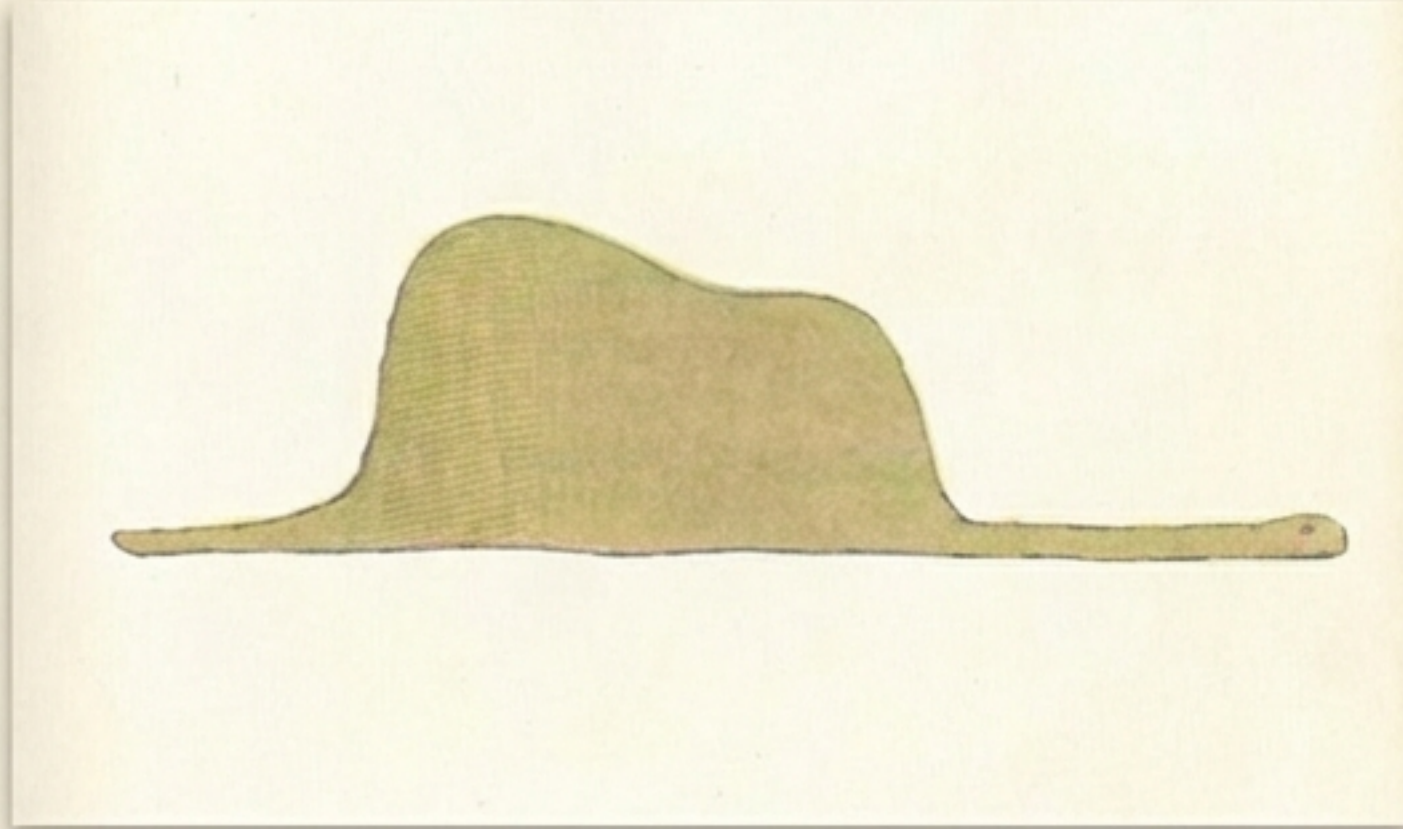
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The Failure of Grown-Up Logic



“Grown-ups never understand anything by themselves, and it is tiresome for children to be always and forever explaining things to them.”

The narrator explains his childhood disillusionment. When he showed his masterpiece to adults, they saw a hat. He had to draw the inside to make them understand. This establishes the recurring theme: adults look at the surface; children (and the Prince) look within.

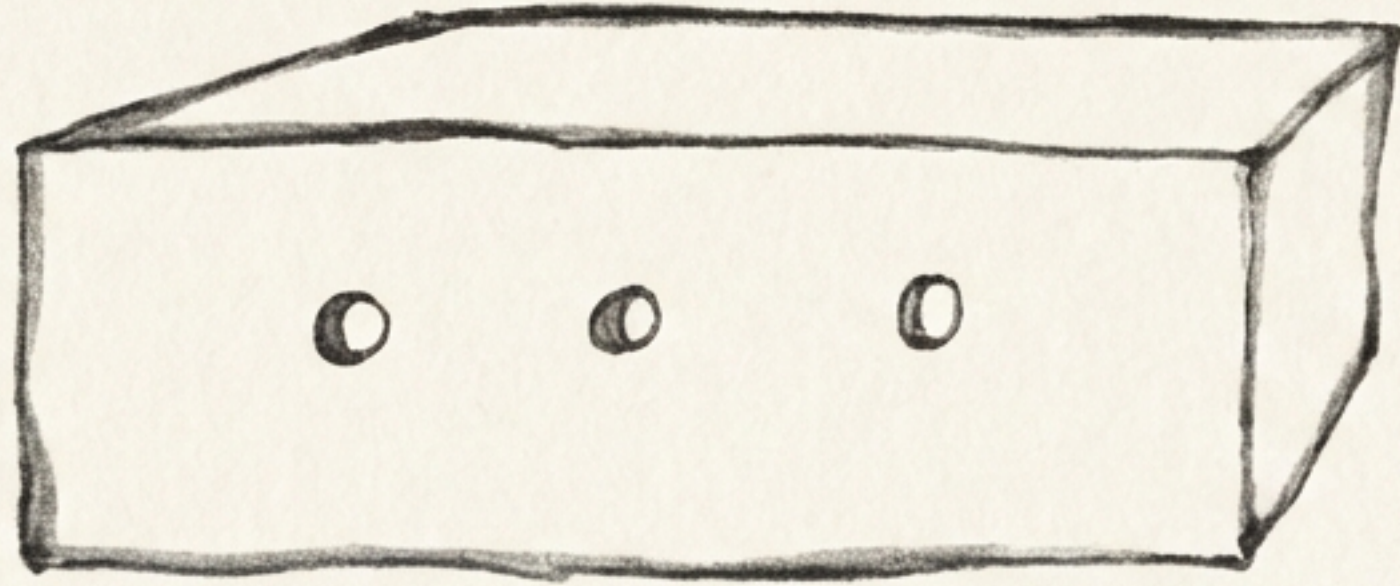
Draw Me a Sheep



A mysterious child appears with a strange request. He does not need water or help; he needs a friend. But realism fails:

- One sheep is too sickly.
- One is a ram (it has horns).
- One is too old.

The Perfection of the Invisible



“This is only his box. The sheep you asked for is inside.”

Frustrated, the narrator draws a box. To his surprise, the Prince is delighted. The Prince can see the sheep sleeping inside. This moment defines their friendship. The Prince values what cannot be seen with the eyes—a concept that transcends the language barrier of the script on the page.

“Planet B-612”

The Prince’s home is scarcely larger than a house.

“Adults love figures. If you tell them about a new friend, they ask ‘How much does his father earn?’ If you tell them about the asteroid, they only believe you if you give them the number B-612.”

Note the small volcanic craters and the single flower in the bud.



The Discipline of the Baobabs



Before they grow big, baobabs start as little weeds. If you don't recognize them in time, they split the planet in pieces. The Dzongkha script wrapping around the roots highlights the universal danger of neglecting one's internal garden.

སྤྲོད་པོ་བཞི་པ།

“It is a question of discipline...
You must see to it that you
pull up the baobabs regularly.”

Forty-Four Sunsets



The Prince reveals his sadness:
“One loves the sunset, when
one is so sad.”

On his planet, the days are so
short he once watched the sun
set 44 times in one day, simply
by moving his chair a few steps.

“The Rose” in Playfair Display

She did not appear like the other simple wildflowers. She took days to prepare her petals. She is stunning, but she is also vain, demanding, and contradictory.

She demands a screen to protect her from drafts. She torments the Prince with her vanity, causing him to doubt his love for her.



The Great Migration



Believing he cannot please the Rose, the Prince decides to leave. He cleans his volcanoes and says goodbye.

At the last moment, the Rose drops her defenses. 'I have been silly,' she says. 'Try to be happy.' But the Prince leaves anyway.



Asteroid 325: The King

Authority without Subjects

The Logic: He claims to rule the universe, but he only gives orders that can be obeyed (e.g., ordering the sun to set, but only at sunset).

The Prince's Reaction: "Grown-ups are very strange." Authority serves no purpose if there is no one to serve.

Asteroid 326: The Vain Man

The Need for Validation

The Logic: He hears only praise. He asks the Prince to clap his hands just so he can tip his hat. He demands to be admired as the finest man on the planet, even though he is the only man on the planet.

“To admire means that you regard me as the handsomest, the best-dressed, the richest, and the most intelligent man on this planet.”



Asteroid 327: The Drunkard

The Cycle of Shame



Prince: Why are you drinking?

Drunkard: To forget.

Prince: To forget what?

Drunkard: To forget that I am ashamed.

Prince: Ashamed of what?

Drunkard: Ashamed of drinking.



Asteroid 328: The Businessman

Possession without Utility

The Logic:

He counts the stars to “own” them. He writes the number on a piece of paper and puts it in a drawer.

The Prince’s Rebuttal:

The Prince owns a flower and volcanoes, and he is useful to them. The Businessman is of no use to the stars. “That is not serious.”

Asteroid 329: The Lamplighter

Duty and Absurdity

The Logic:

His planet turns faster and faster. He must light the lamp and put it out once every minute. He has no rest.

The Prince's Respect:

"He is the only one of them all who does not seem to me ridiculous. Perhaps that is because he is thinking of something else besides himself."



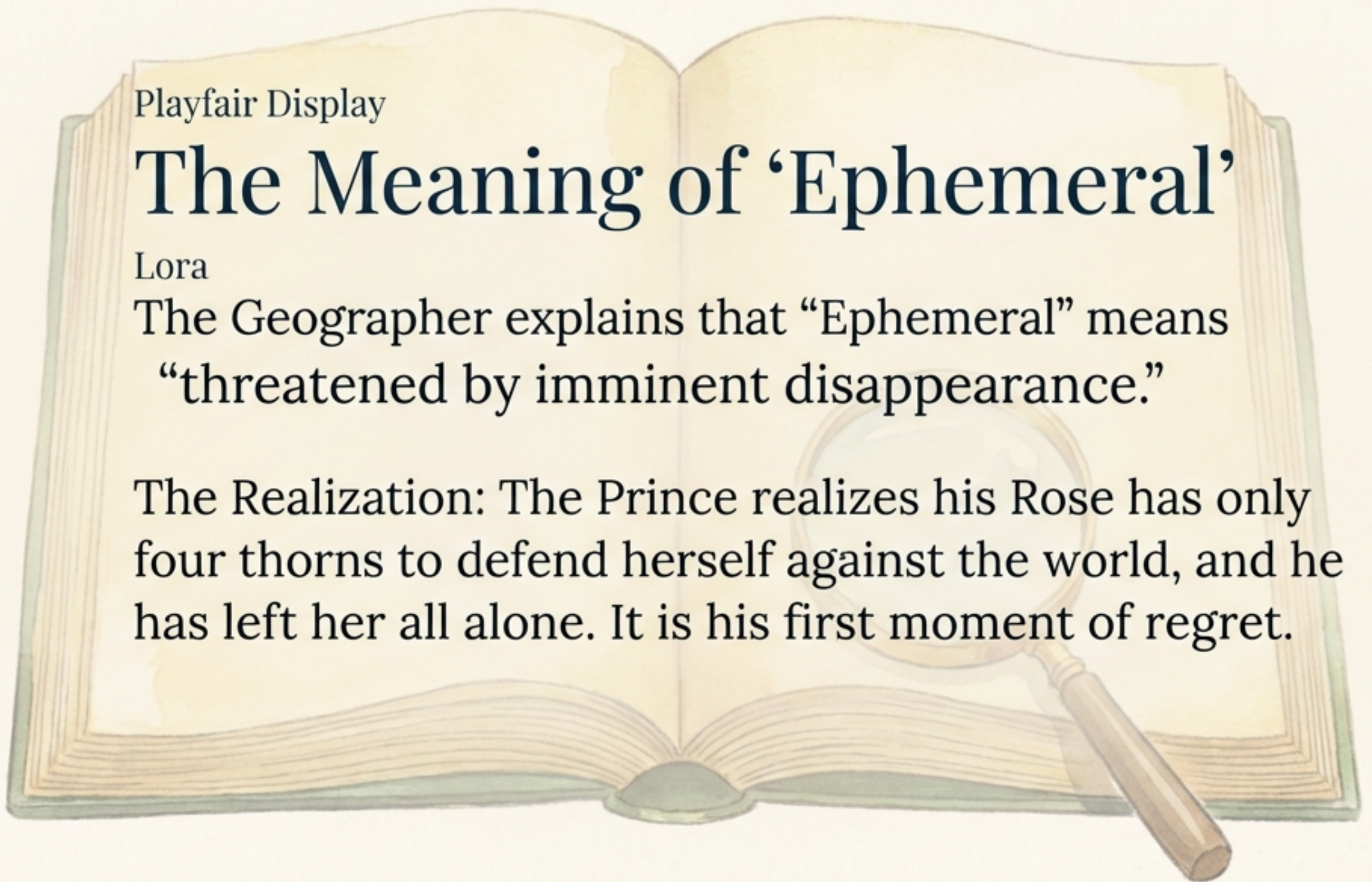


Asteroid 330: The Geographer in Playfair Display

Theory over Experience

The Logic: He writes huge books but never leaves his desk. He relies on explorers but rejects them if they are drunk or lying. He knows where the oceans are, but not if they have water in them.

Key Moment: He asks the Prince to describe his planet. The Prince mentions the Rose. The Geographer refuses to record it.



Playfair Display

The Meaning of 'Ephemeral'

Lora

The Geographer explains that "Ephemeral" means
"threatened by imminent disappearance."

The Realization: The Prince realizes his Rose has only
four thorns to defend herself against the world, and he
has left her all alone. It is his first moment of regret.

Destination: Earth



“The planet Earth,”
replied the geographer.
“It has a good
reputation.”

On the advice of the Geographer, the Prince sets off for the seventh planet: Earth. This marks the end of the ‘Travelogue’ through the asteroids and the beginning of his final lessons.

Seeing with the Heart

ང་གིས་ལྷན་དེ་བ་འདི་ མི་རྣམས་ཚེས་ཚུ་ལུ་ གུས་བཀྱར་ཁུ་ནི་འོ་དོན་ལས་ སུལ་ཕྱ་ཡིན་མ་ལས་ ཡ་
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We have journeyed through the stars using the visual language of Saint-Exupéry and the written language of the Himalayas. Whether read in French, English, or Dzongkha, the lesson remains the same:

**“One sees clearly only with the heart.
What is essential is invisible to the eye.”**

This edition is a testament to that invisible, universal thread.

འོངམ་ཡིན། (དེ་འབདཱ་ད་ མི་དག་པ་ཅིག་གིས་རྒྱུངམ་ཅིག་སེམས་ཁར་བྲན་མ་ཡིནམ།) དེ་
འབདཱ་ལས་ དེ་གི་ གུས་བཀྱར་འདི་ལེགས་བཅོས་འབདཱ་ཡིན།